

Carl Avidano

User Experience
Design Systems
Accessibility

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(he/him)
Based in New York

Summary

UX leader, researcher, and design systems engineer with over 20 years of experience in government, nonprofit, education, healthcare, and civic technology sectors. Led UX strategy and information architecture for Phoenix.gov, serving 1.5+ million residents. Spent four years at NYC OTI simplifying public services and internal workflows, including emergency alerts and donation management. Through Avidano Digital, led digital projects for international nonprofits, including UNICEF's Funding Marketplace used in 80+ countries and the Cheetah Conservation Fund's global website. Created Natura11y, an open-source design system.

Skills

UX Research and Strategy, Information Architecture, Stakeholder Alignment, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Agentic Workflows, Accessibility and Inclusive Design, Visual and Graphic Design, Front-End Development (HTML/CSS/JavaScript/React), Leadership, Management and Mentorship, Cross-Functional Collaboration

Tools: Figma/FigJam, Optimal Workshop, Adobe Creative Cloud, Confluence/Jira, VS Code/Claude/Cursor/Codex, GitHub

Experience

UX/UI Director | Reingold

March 2022 — August 2026

- Led and contributed to qualitative and quantitative UX research across large government and mission-driven programs; managed and mentored UX designers through project direction, design critiques, feedback, and career development.
- **Phoenix.gov (city serving 1.5+ million residents):** Defined the research approach and led the team's execution. Conducted stakeholder interviews across 40+ city departments, created personas and user journeys, developed information architecture recommendations, and validated the new sitemap through tree testing with nearly 100 residents using Optimal Workshop. Translated findings into wireframes, navigation strategy, and low-fidelity prototypes. The redesign launched ahead of schedule with a cleaner information architecture, reduced content burden, and strong accessibility standards.
- **Legal Aid Disaster Resource Center (LADRC):** Led qualitative research, including remote usability testing over Zoom and in-person testing in Des Moines during a legal aid conference. Recruited participants through channels including Craigslist and Amazon Mechanical Turk.
- **Maximus:** Led a research-heavy engagement including stakeholder interviews, personas, and detailed user journeys, and facilitated information architecture work directly with the client, including an in-person sitemap workshop in Washington, DC.
- **State of Nebraska design system pilot:** Grew a small exploratory effort into work supporting a broader statewide implementation, translating design system thinking into practical Figma components and patterns aligned with an Adobe Experience Manager (AEM) rollout.
- **Global pediatric medical platform:** Led UX and design strategy for a platform connecting doctors worldwide to improve pediatric cancer care, facilitating stakeholder workshops and delivering both wireframes and high-fidelity designs.
- Contributed to projects for NFL Players Community, the South Carolina Department of Transportation (SCDOT), and the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (REACH).
- Advocated for accessibility as an integral part of the research and design process across all engagements.

Senior UX Designer | NYC Office of Technology & Innovation (OTI)

September 2017 — March 2022

- Contributed to UX discovery through stakeholder interviews and internal research on public-facing city services.
- Designed the UI and developed the front-end for NYC Poletop Manager, a GIS mapping application used to track and manage 5G and smart-city infrastructure on utility poles across all five boroughs.
- Designed and built the front-end for the Materials for the Arts (MFTA) donation management system, streamlining manual workflows for warehouse staff and volunteers.
- Redesigned the Notify NYC website and custom admin portal for citywide emergency alert publishing.
- Oversaw UX strategy and designs for the NYC311 mobile app (iOS and Android) redesign.

Owner / Principal | Avidano Digital

February 2011 — Present (independent practice, run concurrently with the full-time roles above)

- Created and continue to maintain Natura11y, an open-source, AI-ready design system that includes reusable patterns, documentation, Figma UI kits, and front-end components.
- Designed UNICEF's Funding Marketplace, a prescriptive CMS that enabled 80+ country offices to manage fundraising campaigns; led interaction design and front-end development; simplified complex user flows; and collaborated with back-end developers on QA, documenting issues and resolutions. The platform supported more than \$300 million in revenue between 2010 and 2016.
- Led the redesign of the Cheetah Conservation Fund website on a custom WordPress multisite platform, increasing donation-page traffic by 59% and online campaign revenue by 38%.
- Rebranded and redesigned Visionlearning's bilingual STEM platform with 100+ learning modules. Designed the authoring workflow and built interactive annotations linking readings to Next Generation Science Standards (NGSS). Improved accessibility, mobile usability, and course organization.
- Redesigned and built Mr. Ellie Pooh's e-commerce website on a custom Shopify theme, achieving a 10X increase in online sales.

Interactive Designer | Underline Communications

August 2010 — January 2011

- Designed websites, promotional emails, and banner campaigns for American Express.
- Produced wireframes, mock-ups, and client-facing presentations.
- Developed front-end templates for microsites.

Freelance Web Designer | Spiegel Design Group (SDG)

August 2009 — August 2010

- Created detailed website mock-ups and presentation materials for national fashion, retail, and nonprofit clientele including Lauren Moshi, Children Uniting Nations, and Animal Medical Center of Southern California.
- Created logos and brand marketing materials, often working on tight timelines.

Web Designer | Swanson Russell

September 2006 — July 2009

- Created website mock-ups and front-end templates for clients including E-Z-GO and Union Bank & Trust.
- Developed microsites using Flash (ActionScript 3.0).
- Led and taught "Lunch and Learns".
- Art directed entry-level designers and production artists for web and print projects.

Web and Graphic Designer | Bozell

November 2003 — July 2006

- Developed websites and designed marketing materials for regional and national clients.
- Contributed to brand development for National YWCA and Alegent Health.
- Prepared print-ready artwork for direct mail, brochures, and outdoor campaigns.

Education

AOS, Graphic Design and Illustration — The Creative Center, College of Art and Design